
4.3 Clinical psychology

Students will be assessed on their ability to:

- 1 **Definition of the application**
 - a Define clinical psychology understanding that it is about explaining and treating mental illness.
 - b Define and use psychological terminology accurately and appropriately including:
 - i statistical definition of abnormality
 - ii social norm definition of abnormality
 - iii schizophrenia
 - iv reliability
 - v validity
 - vi primary data and secondary data.
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- 2 **Methodology/ How Science Works**
 - a Describe what is meant by primary and secondary data in doing research.
 - b Evaluate the use of primary and secondary data in doing research.
 - c Explain how issues of validity and reliability arise in clinical psychology.
 - d Describe and evaluate **two** research methods used in the study of schizophrenia, including one study for each of the two research methods to illustrate the use of the relevant method.

Suitable examples:

 - twin studies
 - case studies
 - animal experiments.

3 Content

- a Describe both the statistical definition of abnormality and the 'social norms' definition of abnormality.
- b Evaluate the statistical definition of abnormality and the 'social norms' definition of abnormality in terms of their suitability as definitions of abnormality.
- c Using the findings of studies, describe and evaluate reliability, validity and cultural issues with regard to the diagnosis of disorders (including use of Diagnostic and Statistical Manual (DSM)).
- d For schizophrenia and **one** other disorder (selected from unipolar depression, bipolar depression, phobias, obsessive compulsive disorder, anorexia nervosa and bulimia nervosa) describe the features and symptoms.
- e For schizophrenia describe and evaluate two explanations. Students must select one explanation each from two different approaches from the five studied in Units 1 and 2.
- f For **one** other disorder (selected from unipolar depression, bipolar depression, phobias, obsessive compulsive disorder, anorexia nervosa and bulimia nervosa) describe and evaluate **two** explanations. Students must select one explanation each from two different approaches from the five studied in Units 1 and 2.
- g For schizophrenia describe and evaluate **two** treatments. Students must select one treatment each from two different approaches studied from the five in Units 1 and 2.
- h For **one** other disorder (selected from unipolar depression, bipolar depression, phobias, obsessive compulsive disorder, anorexia nervosa and bulimia nervosa) describe and evaluate **two** treatments. Students must select one treatment each from two different approaches from the five studied in Units 1 and 2.

Suitable examples:

- the Social Approach, eg Family Therapy or Care in the Community programmes
- the Cognitive Approach, eg Cognitive Behaviour Therapy or Rational Emotive Therapy
- the Psychodynamic Approach, eg free association or dream analysis
- the Biological Approach, eg the use of drugs (chemotherapy) or electro-convulsive therapy (ECT)
- the Learning Approach, eg the Token Economy Programme or Systematic Desensitisation.

i Describe and evaluate **one** treatment/therapy from **each** of the following approaches:

- i the Social Approach: either Family Therapy or Care in the Community programmes
- ii the Cognitive Approach: either Cognitive Behaviour Therapy or Rational Emotive Therapy
- iii the Psychodynamic Approach: either free association or dream analysis
- iv the Biological Approach: either the use of drugs (chemotherapy) or electro-convulsive therapy (ECT)
- v the Learning Approach: either the Token Economy Programme or Systematic Desensitisation.

4 Studies in detail

- a Describe and evaluate Rosenhan (1973) On being sane in insane places and **two other** studies. One other study must focus on schizophrenia and one other study must focus on one other chosen disorder.

Suitable examples:

eg for schizophrenia

- Goldstein (1988) Gender differences in the course of schizophrenia
- Lewine et al (1990) Sexual dimorphism in brain morphology and schizophrenia

eg for unipolar depression, bipolar depression, phobias, obsessive compulsive disorder, anorexia nervosa and bulimia nervosa

- Brown et al (1986) Social support, self-esteem and depression
- Mumford and Whitehouse (1988) Increased prevalence of bulimia nervosa among Asian schoolgirls
- Cook and Mineka (1989) Observational conditioning of fear to fear-relevant versus fear-irrelevant stimuli in rhesus monkeys
- Mineka and Ohma (2002) Learning and unlearning fears: Preparedness neural pathways and patients.

5 Evidence in practice: short practical on a key issue

- a Describe **one** key issue in clinical psychology, using the areas of study covered within the application

Suitable examples:

- understanding a mental health disorder
- supporting someone with a mental health disorder in the home
- supporting someone with a mental health disorder in work
- the way that mental illness is portrayed in the media.

- b Prepare a leaflet using secondary data for a particular audience about the key issue. Include a commentary on the leaflet explaining why decisions were made, who the audience was and what outcomes were intended.